MICHAEL MAI

Creative Technology · Communications · Customer Experience
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PROFILE

Communications and customer-experience professional combining hospitality, retail and financial-services experience with hands-on creative technology projects. Connects cultural storytelling, audience-focused communication and AI-assisted production using Blender, Unreal Engine and editable design tools.

SELECTED CREATIVE PROJECTS

Huế Citadel — Ngọ Môn study: Directed an AI-assisted Blender entrance study informed by architectural references; produced an editable scene and rendered overview with documented scope limits.

Saigon Plaza: Shaped a Vietnamese café environment project through cultural direction, review and testing. Project evidence includes Unreal captures and an original three-prop Blender/FBX batch with documented export checks.

SIGNAL / AI: Developed an agency concept with AI-assisted production: a 14-slide pitch deck with speaker notes, desktop/mobile interface designs and a brand/UI board. Concept work, not a launched client business.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Trung Nguyen Legend Cafe — Westminster, CA

Barista / Administrative Assistant / Community Manager | 2023–Present

- Support café operations and introduce Vietnamese coffee culture through product education, brand storytelling and customer engagement.
- Assist with inventory, scheduling, reporting, marketing and community communications; help refine operational processes.

loanDepot — Irvine, CA

Customer Lending Representative | December 2021–May 2022

- Helped customers understand lending products, requirements and next steps through needs-based conversations and clear follow-up.
- Documented customer information in digital systems while managing high-volume conversations.

Gap — South Coast Plaza, Costa Mesa, CA

Brand Associate | 2015–2021

- Provided product guidance and supported merchandising, replenishment and sales-floor operations in a high-traffic retail environment.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

VietRISE — Volunteer / Facilitator | 2022–Present
Support outreach and guide middle- and high-school students through discussions of cultural identity and community history.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

California State University, Long Beach — B.A., Communication Studies; Marketing minor, 2020.
Certificates: Mediation & Dispute Resolution; Professional Selling.
INNOCEAN advertising-agency classes during the pandemic; early exposure to AI.

SKILLS

Audience-focused writing · Cross-cultural communication · Customer education · Operations support · Blender · Unreal Engine · AI-assisted creative workflows · Production documentation · Windows, macOS and Linux